

Engineering Hub & Real Estate

"Pune was known as an entrepreneurs' town in the 60s, not so much in the retail sector but in the engineering field where a lot of automotive designs and components were being prepared. It is this strong engineering culture that has spilled over to the IT sector. "Brick & Mortar companies like Bajaj Auto, Kinetic, Tata Motors, Daimler Chrysler and Greaves all have their engineering divisions in Pune."

Companies prefer to set up their R&D centres in Pune because of its proximity to Mumbai and the ready availability of manpower in which Pune scores above others in this area. It pays to set up the R&D centre away from the commercial hub so that business considerations do not interfere with hardcore R&D activity.

A prime example of such 'industrial' preference for Pune is the case of Premium Energy Transmission Ltd, which has its headquarters in the city. The company's parent is the prestigious Greaves Gears - the largest and most renowned gear manufacturers of the country.

Premium Energy Transmission Ltd. was formed to handle the Power Transmission Business with greater focus and technology initiatives and has, within a short while, reached the top. It now stands as one of the most diversified power transmission company in the world with its product range encompassing a wide variety viz. worm gears, helical gears, bevel helical combinations planetary gears, worm and helical geared motors etc.

To quote them on their success mantra in this highly competitive world, "Premium retains its edge by empowering the employees in their journey of excellence. Great emphasis is placed on Human Resource Development and Training to equip the employees with knowledge and skills to face the emerging challenges with high degree of success. This sense of teamwork also extends to company's dealers and other associates who play an equally important role in delivering the highest quality and customer satisfaction that is a hallmark of Premium. This committed and motivated team keeps Premium always ahead with cutting edge competitiveness. Building on this solid foundation Premium plans to extend its leadership in power transmission to a global level by acquiring new technologies launching new products and redefining customer expectations about the performance of power transmission products.

"Currently the real estate market is going through a correction in prices and there are increased possibilities that the artificially inflated prices are likely to come down.

One of the biggest projects in the recent times that has captured the imagination of the country is the Magarpatta city by Magarpatta Township Development and Construction Company Ltd. Spread over 400 acres of prime land, Magarpatta City was a dream to create a new way of life. 120 families of Magarpatta came together, pooled in their ancestral land and proposed an innovative this 4000-crore integrated township with the core idea of 'Walk-to-Work, Walk-to-School'.

Satish Magar, chairman and managing director of Magarpatta Township Development and Construction Company Ltd. explains the project mission, "Our



mission is to create a new way of life for the networked society of the new millennium with emphasis on proper environment control, good living standards, modern educational system and state-of the-art working conditions with total security".

Apart from offering an elite lifestyle, Magarpatta City has also contributed significantly to the society. Their CSR list is enviably long as Mr Magar elaborates about the labour creche, education and health facilities on the site of construction. "Over 500 children of labourers aged 0-12 are given formal and informal education through an NGO called Interveda India-Awaking (Jagruiti) at a creche built for them in Magarpatta City, in third phase. These children are provided with nourishing breakfast, lunch, evening snacks, uniforms toys and also regular medical and health check-ups for a healthy upbringing. Their practical training includes basic awareness of environment, learning alphabets, signages, road signs, greetings, poems, group songs, mannerisms, body cleanliness, dental care and hygiene etc. They are taken on theme picnics and study tours to give them an exposure of the outside world. Four children from this creche have been nominated for free education in government-aided schools."

He says that, "Fitness-A way of life for everyone here". "A medical health check up was held at our site office for over 2500 construction workers of Magarpatta City between 18 April and 1 May 2007 under the aegis of Noble Hospital. Doctors and consultants from Noble Hospital ensured the labourers were examined and diagnosed for blood tests sugar blood pressure and general. Also a vaccination camp for over 600 children of labours, aged 0-5", he adds.

So successful has this project idea been, that another one called Nanded City is modelled after it. Nanded City, a modern mega township of 700 acre, is a dream of 235 farmer families of Nanded & Khadakwasla village with an aspiration of turning their small hamlet into a Nanded City.

A seamless blend of nature and an ultra modern lifestyle, Nanded City is a futuristic integrated township carved between the rejuvenating environments of Pune Khadakwasla-Sinhagad Road and the pulsating main Pune City.

Nestled in the picturesque settings, the township offers the finest of living spaces with infrastructure for an Animation & Gaming Park, IT Park, Research institutes, Sports institutes, Educational institutes, Global Corporate Houses, Hotels, Multi-cuisine Restaurants, Multiplex, Mall, Banks and Retail outlets.

Even as such high end townships continue to crop up, we asked Mr Magar what his views are about the current real estate scenario with respect to rise in interest rates? "There is still a market for middle class genuine buyers. The effect that will come in with rise in interest rate would be that the sizes of flats may reduce", he replies convincingly.